

February 3, 2006



U.S. Department
of Transportation

400 Seventh Street, S.W.
Washington, D.C. 20590

**Pipeline and
Hazardous Materials
Safety Administration**

DOT-SP 13957
(FIRST REVISION)

EXPIRATION DATE: December 31, 2007

(FOR RENEWAL, SEE 49 CFR § 107.109)

1. GRANTEE: T.L.C.C., Inc.
Franklin, TN
2. PURPOSE AND LIMITATIONS:
 - a. This special permit authorizes the manufacture, marking, sale and use of a non-DOT specification, liner-less, fully-wrapped fiberglass composite cylinder for the transportation in commerce of the materials authorized by this special permit. This special permit provides no relief from the Hazardous Materials Regulations (HMR) other than as specifically stated herein.
 - b. The safety analyses performed in development of this special permit only considered the hazards and risks associated with transportation in commerce. The safety analyses did not consider the hazards and risks associated with consumer use, use as a component of a transport vehicle or other device, or other uses not associated with transportation in commerce.
3. REGULATORY SYSTEM AFFECTED: 49 CFR Parts 106, 107 and 171-180.
4. REGULATIONS FROM WHICH EXEMPTED: 49 CFR §§ 173.304a(a)(1) and 175.3 in that the use of a non-DOT specification packaging is not authorized therein except as specified herein.

NOTE: This does not relieve the holder of this special permit from securing and maintaining a valid approval for manufacturing cylinders from the Associate Administrator for Hazardous Materials Safety.

5. BASIS: This special permit is based on the application of T.L.C.C., Inc. dated September 29, 2004 submitted in accordance with § 107.105 and the public proceeding thereon and all information submitted for DOT-SP 13105. An additional letter dated January 25, 2006 was also submitted.
6. HAZARDOUS MATERIALS (49 CFR § 172.101):

Hazardous Material Description			
Proper Shipping Name	Hazard Class/Division	Identification Number	Packing Group
Compressed gas, flammable, n.o.s.	2.1	UN1954	N/A
Compressed gas, non-flammable, n.o.s.	2.2	UN1956	N/A
Liquefied gas, flammable, n.o.s.	2.1	UN3161	N/A
Liquefied gas, n.o.s.	2.2	UN3163	N/A
Liquefied gases, <i>non-flammable charged with nitrogen, carbon dioxide or air</i>	2.2	UN1058	N/A
Petroleum gases, liquefied	2.1	UN1075	N/A

7. SAFETY CONTROL MEASURES:

a. PACKAGING - Packaging prescribed is a non-DOT specification, liner-less, fully-wrapped fiberglass composite cylinder. The cylinder is a two part cylinder with a ground conical joint, adhesively joined as described in the application for DOT-SP 13105 on file with the Office of Hazardous Materials Special Permits and Approvals (OHMSPA). The cylinder must have a permanently attached thermoplastic outer casing. Manufacture must be in conformance with the requirements described in DOT-SP 13105, with Composite Scandinavia Technical Specifications and Manufacturing Specifications for Compolite CS6(PK6),

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Compolite CS10(PK10), Compolite CS 13 and Compolite CS#10. Cylinders must be designed, manufactured, and tested in conformance with Composite Scandinavia drawings : 0106-00, 0110-00, 0313-00, and 0410-00 and related drawings, on file with the OHMSPA. Cylinders must be in conformance with the following:

(1) Type size and service pressure.

Maximum Volume: 36 Liters

Maximum service pressure: 294 psi (20 bars)

Minimum test pressure: 441 psi (30 bars)

Minimum burst pressure: 882 psi (60 bars)

(2) Inspection. Inspections and verifications required by this special permit must be performed by an independent inspection agency approved in writing by the Associate Administrator for Hazardous Materials Safety in accordance with Title 49, Code of Federal regulations, Subpart I.

(3) Duties of the inspector.

(i) Determine that all materials conform to the provisions of this special permit.

(ii) For each raw material batch, verify conformance of filament and resin system components with the requirements in the special permit.

(iii) Prior to the initial shipment of any specific cylinder design, verify that the design qualification tests prescribed in this special permit have been performed with acceptable results.

(iv) Verify conformance of the completed cylinder with all requirements, including marking, condition of inside, threads and relevant process parameters.

(v) Verify winding process to assure that composite material is uniform, of required thickness and pattern, and in accordance with the composite structure present in cylinders subjected to the design qualification tests.

(vi) Witness all tests and pressurizations, obtain copies of all test results and certifications; report volumetric capacity, and completed composite cylinder weight.

(vii) Furnish completed inspector's report to the manufacturer of the cylinder and upon request, to the purchaser.

(4) Authorized materials and identification of materials.

(i) Filament material must be commercial Type E-fiberglass. Filaments must be tested in accordance with ASTM D-2343-79 and have minimum strand strength of 200,000 psi.

(ii) Resin system must be thermoset vinylester based resin as described in the material specifications on file with the OHMSPA. Resin system must be tested on sample coupons representative of the composite overwrap in accordance with ASTM D-2344-67 for water boil test, and have minimum shear strength of 13.8MPa (2029 psi).

(5) Manufacture.

(i) The composite cylinder is unlined. The two halves of each cylinder are wound with fiberglass then injected with plastic under high pressure in a hermetic process. After hardening, the two halves are taken out of the moulds and then are joined in accordance with a Composite Scandinavia process which meets the requirements of British Health & Safety Executive Standard HSE-LL-FW4, Specification for Fully-Wrapped Linerless Transportable Pressure Receptacles, Issue 3, September 1999. No defect that is likely to weaken the finished cylinder appreciably is acceptable.

(ii) Welding or brazing for any purpose whatsoever is prohibited.

(6) Lot size. A cylinder lot means a group of cylinders successively produced, having the same size and configuration, the same specified materials of

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construction, and the same process of manufacture to the same cylinder specification. In no case may the lot size exceed 200 cylinders; however, any cylinder processed for use in the required destructive tests need not be counted as one of the 200, but must have been processed with the lot.

(7) Wall thickness. The minimum fiber stress ratio (fiber stress at design minimum burst pressure divided by the fiber stress at service pressure) must be 3.4.

(8) Openings. Openings are permitted on the heads only. The center line of openings must coincide with the longitudinal axis of the cylinder. Threads must be clean cut, even, without checks and to gauge.

(9) Pressure relief devices and valve protection. Cylinder must be equipped with a pressure relief device in accordance with § 173.301(f). Protection for valves and other connections must be in accordance with § 173.301(h).

(10) Production testing

(i) Each cylinder must be hydrostatically or pneumatically pressure tested to a pressure of at least 441 psig (30 bar) without measurement of expansion. The cylinder test pressure must be maintained for a sufficiently long period (at least 30 seconds) to ascertain that there are no leaks and no failure. The cylinder shall be rejected if there are leaks, failure to hold pressure, or visible permanent deformation after the cylinder is depressurized. (**Note:** Cracking of resin is not necessarily a sign of permanent deformation.) If leakage occurs in the piping or fittings, the cylinder may be retested after repairing such leakages. Only two such retests are authorized. The pressure gauge must permit reading to an accuracy of 1 percent in the range of 80 percent to 120 percent of test pressure. Cylinders rejected by the pressure test must not be placed in service.

(ii) One cylinder taken at random from each 1000 cylinders must be subjected to cycle testing in accordance with DOT FRP-1 §178.AA-12(b) (See Appendix B of this special permit). Acceptable results must be in accordance with § 178.AA-13(c) and § 178.AA-14(c).

(iii) One cylinder taken at random from each lot of 200 or less cylinders must be hydrostatically burst tested in accordance with DOT FRP-1 § 178.AA-12(c). Acceptable results must be in accordance with § 178.AA-13(d) and § 178.AA-14(d), except that the burst may initiate anywhere on the cylinder (dome or sidewall). If burst occurs at less than 125% of the minimum burst pressure, the cylinder must remain in one piece. Leakage through the boss fusion joint is permitted, provided that the pressure at failure is at least 4 times the design service design.

(11) Inspector's reports & retention of report.

(i) The inspector must prepare a report that is clear, legible, and in accordance with DOT FRP-1 § 178.AA-16 except that testing and criteria relevant to aluminum liners do not apply, and references to FRP-1 must be replaced with this special permit number.

(ii) The inspector's report must be retained for 15 years from the original test date on the cylinder by the manufacturer and by the inspector.

(12) Design qualification tests. Prior to initial shipment of any specific cylinder design, qualification tests must have been performed on representative cylinders with satisfactory results. All cylinders used for design qualification tests must be fabricated on the same equipment and subjected to the same processes as is used to produce cylinders intended for charging and shipment. All tests must be witnessed by an independent inspector. Test reports must be kept on file by the cylinder manufacturer and made available to

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the independent inspector and the OHMS upon request. Design changes must be as defined in DOT FRP-1 § 178.AA-18(b). Required testing for design changes must be as specified in DOT FRP-1 § 178.AA-18(c). The following design qualification tests must be performed:

(i) High Temperature Creep. Two cylinders shall be hydraulically pressurized to test pressure and shall be maintained at this pressure for at least 1,000 hours. The test shall be conducted at a minimum temperature of 70°C and a relative humidity of less than 50%. After this test, the cylinders shall be subjected to the leak test and the burst test. The cylinder shall not exhibit any visible deformation or loose (unraveling) fibers. The cylinder shall pass the leak test and the burst pressure shall be equal to or greater than 2 times the test pressure. Leak test. Acceptable methods for leakage testing include bubble testing using dry air or gas or measurement of trace gases using a mass spectrometer. Leak testing must be performed at service pressure. No leakage in excess of the permeation rate of 0.25 ml/h/L water capacity shall be permitted.

(ii) Permeability Test. Two cylinders shall be hydraulically pressure cycled 1000 cycles from zero to service pressure, and then weighed empty. The cylinders shall then be filled to service pressure with LPG at a temperature of 15°C. The cylinders shall be weighed after 1,7,14,21, and 28 days, emptied and weighed empty after testing. Requirement: Maximum loss of weight rate $q < 0.25$ (ml/h/L water capacity). The calculation should be modified so that the difference between empty weight before and after the test is not integrated in the loss of weight rate.

In addition to the above, the permeability test must be performed at a temperature no less than 54°C (130°F), checked with infrared spectrophotometry, to confirm rate of product loss not exceeding 120 grams per year.

(iii) Flawed Cylinder Test. Two cylinders shall be prepared with cuts into the composite approximately in the following manner: Two flaws on each cylinder: Width = 1mm, length = 5 times

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the composite thickness, depth = at least 40% of the composite thickness. One cut shall be longitudinal and the other transverse in the cylindrical part along two planes forming an angle of 120 degrees. One cylinder shall withstand the ambient pressure cycling test to 5000 cycles, while the other cylinder shall withstand the burst test to at least $4/3$ times the test pressure.

(iv) Drop Test. Two cylinders shall be filled with water to the weight equal to maximal service content. The cylinders shall be dropped from the height of 1.2m onto a smooth, unyielding surface (steel, concrete, etc.) twice in the following five positions, giving a total of ten drops: (1) vertically onto the bottom end, (2) 45 degrees onto the bottom end, (3) horizontally, (4) 45 degrees onto the valve end, and (5) vertically onto the valve end. Visual damage shall be noted after each drop. After dropping, one cylinder shall withstand the ambient pressure cycling test, while the other cylinder shall withstand the burst test.

(v) Torque test on cylinder neck boss. The cylinder shall be fitted with a valve and tightened to 150% of the maximum torque recommended by the manufacturer. The valve shall be removed after the first installation and the neck thread and boss inspected. The procedure shall then be repeated. A test for leaks in the cylinder neck or the permeability test shall be conducted at service pressure for at least 10 minutes. The neck thread and boss shall show no significant deformation and shall remain within drawing and gauge tolerance. Leakage greater than 1 bubble in 2 minutes in the bubble leak test or failure of the permeability test shall constitute a failure of the test.

(vi) Water boil test. One closed unpressurized cylinder shall be subjected to boiling water for 100 hours. The cylinder shall be entirely covered by water. The temperature shall be minimum 97.5°C. On completion of the test, the cylinder shall be submitted to hydraulic pressure to burst, in accordance with 7.a.(10)(iii) of this special permit. The burst pressure or pressure at failure

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shall not be less than 2 times the minimum test pressure of the cylinder design. The burst shall not result in separation at the joint.

(vii) The following design qualification tests must be performed in accordance with the procedures and accept/reject criteria of §178.AA-18 of the DOT FRP-1 Standard (See Appendix B of this special permit):

- Pressure Cycling Tests (Ambient, Environmental, and Thermal)
- Hydraulic Burst Test
- Gunfire Test
- Bonfire Test, except that venting may occur other than through the pressure relief device.

b. REQUALIFICATION TESTING - At least every 5 years, each cylinder must be visually inspected and proof pressure tested. The retest and inspection must be performed with the outer casing in place. Persons performing requalification functions must comply with § 180.205(b).

(1) Proof pressure testing must be to at least 30 bars test pressure in accordance with paragraph 7.a.(10)(i) of this special permit.

(2) Visual inspection must be performed on the outer casing and the non-protected composite areas only. A strong backlight shall be used. Visual inspection and acceptance criteria must be in accordance with Appendix A of this special permit. Repair of the cylinder is not authorized. Cylinders meeting the criteria for rejection must be scrapped.

(3) Removal or replacement of the outer casing may only be performed by personnel authorized by the manufacturer.

(4) Retest markings must be in accordance with §§ 180.213(d) and (e). Retest markings must be applied on a label securely affixed to the cylinder and overcoated with epoxy, near the original test date. Metal stamping of the composite surface is prohibited.

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c. OPERATIONAL CONTROLS -

(1) A cylinder that has been subjected to fire may not be returned to service.

(2) Cylinders must be packaged in accordance with the requirements in § 173.301(a)(9).

(3) Cylinder service life may not exceed 15 years from the date of manufacture as marked on the cylinder.

(4) Filling requirements are subject to all terms contained in §§ 173.304 and 173.304a for DOT 4BA specification cylinders. Person refilling cylinders authorized by this special permit must follow manufacturer's recommendations for pre-fill inspections.

d. MARKING -

(1) Each cylinder must be permanently marked as prescribed in DOT FRP-1 Standard "Basic Requirements for Fiber Reinforced Plastic (FRP) Type 3FC Composite Cylinders § 178.AA-15.

(2) Each cylinder must be marked "DOT-SP 13957".

8. SPECIAL PROVISIONS:

a. In accordance with the provisions of Paragraph (b) of § 173.22a, persons may use the packaging authorized by this special permit for the transportation of the hazardous materials specified in paragraph 6, only in conformance with the terms of this special permit.

b. A person who is not a holder of this special permit, but receives a package covered by this special permit, may reoffer it for transportation provided no modification or change is made to the package or its contents and it is offered for transportation in conformance with this special permit and the HMR.

c. A current copy of this special permit must be maintained at each facility where the package is offered or reoffered for transportation.

- d. Each packaging manufactured under the authority of this special permit must be either (1) marked with the name of the manufacturer and location (city and state) of the facility at which it is manufactured or (2) marked with a registration symbol designated by the Office of Hazardous Materials Special Permits and Approvals for a specific manufacturing facility.
- e. A current copy of this special permit must be maintained at each facility where the package is manufactured under this special permit. It must be made available to a DOT representative upon request.
- f. The cylinders described in this special permit are authorized only for normal transportation as an article of commerce i.e., the movement of hazardous materials packages from consignor to consignee.
- g. For each original design type, the results of design qualification tests must be submitted to the Office of Hazardous Materials Special Permits and Approvals (OHMSPA) before first shipment.
9. MODES OF TRANSPORTATION AUTHORIZED: Motor vehicle, rail freight, cargo vessel, and cargo aircraft only.
10. MODAL REQUIREMENTS: A current copy of this special permit must be carried aboard each cargo vessel or aircraft used to transport packages covered by this special permit. The shipper must furnish a current copy of this special permit to the air carrier before or at the time the shipment is tendered.
11. COMPLIANCE: Failure by a person to comply with any of the following may result in suspension or revocation of this special permit and penalties prescribed by the Federal hazardous materials transportation law, 49 U.S.C. 5101 et seq:
- o All terms and conditions prescribed in this special permit and the Hazardous Materials Regulations, 49 CFR Parts 171-180.
 - o Persons operating under the terms of this special permit must comply with the security plan requirement in Subpart I of Part 172 of the HMR, when applicable.

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- o Registration required by § 107.601 et seq., when applicable.

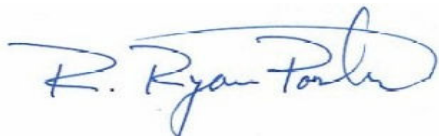
Each "Hazmat employee", as defined in § 171.8, who performs a function subject to this special permit must receive training on the requirements and conditions of this special permit in addition to the training required by §§ 172.700 through 172.704.

No person may use or apply this special permit, including display of its number, when this special permit has expired or is otherwise no longer in effect.

Under Title VII of the Safe, Accountable, Flexible, Efficient Transportation Equity Act: A Legacy for Users (SAFETEA-LU)- 'The Hazardous Materials Safety and Security Reauthorization Act of 2005' (Pub. L. 109-59), 119 Stat. 1144 (August 10, 2005), amended the Federal hazardous materials transportation law by changing the term 'exemption' to 'special permit' and authorizes a special permit to be granted up to two years for new special permits and up to four years for renewals.

12. REPORTING REQUIREMENTS: Shipments or operations conducted under this special permit are subject to the Hazardous Materials Incident Reporting requirements specified in 49 CFR §§ 171.15 - Immediate notice of certain hazardous materials incidents, and 171.16 - Detailed hazardous materials incident reports. In addition, the grantee(s) of this special permit must notify the Associate Administrator for Hazardous Materials Safety, in writing, of any incident involving a package, shipment or operation conducted under terms of this special permit.

Issued in Washington, D.C.

A handwritten signature in blue ink, appearing to read "R. Ryan Porter" or similar, with a stylized flourish.

for Robert A. McGuire
Associate Administrator for
Hazardous Materials Safety

Address all inquiries to: Associate Administrator for Hazardous Materials Safety, Pipeline and Hazardous Materials Safety Administration, Department of Transportation, Washington, D.C. 20590. Attention: PHH-31.

Copies of this special permit may be obtained by accessing the Hazardous Materials Safety Homepage at http://hazmat.dot.gov/sp_app/special_permits/spec_perm_index.htm Photo reproductions and legible reductions of this special permit are permitted. Any alteration of this special permit is prohibited.

PO: CWF/AM

APPENDIX A

Visual Inspection Acceptance/Rejection Criteria

Note: Repair of the cylinder is not authorized. Cylinders meeting the criteria for rejection must be scrapped. Removal or replacement of the outer casing must only be performed by personnel authorized by the manufacturer.

Type of damage	Description	Rejection limits
Abrasion damage or damage from cuts	Abrasion damage is caused by wearing, grinding or rubbing material away by friction. Cuts or gouges are caused by contact with sharp objects in such a way as to cut into the composite, reducing its thickness at that point.	- Depth: more than 10% of composite overwrap thickness or - Total length of cut(s): more than 50% of the diameter of the cylinder or - Damaged area: maximum diameter more than 50% of the diameter of the cylinder. Note 1: The maximum diameter of the damaged area is the diameter of the smallest circle which includes the damaged area. Note 2: Intra-laminar hairline cracks (between fibers, typically on the circumference after proof testing) is allowed if not in combination with impact damage. Note 3: Scratches that do not sever a fiber are not included in the above.
Delamination and impact damage	An Inter-laminar delamination is a separation of layers of strands. An Intra-laminar delamination is a separation between strands within the same layer. It may appear as a whitish patch like a blister or an air bubble beneath the surface.	Impact damage that has caused surface damage including delamination, is not acceptable. Impact damage made by a pointed object that has caused delamination and surface damage is not acceptable. A delamination that runs through more than one layer

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	Impact damage may appear as hairline cracks in the resin or delamination or cuts of the composite.	is not acceptable. For a bulge (cavity) internally in the composite overwrap, the maximum diameter of the bulge shall not exceed 10% of the composite thickness. Any bulge in combination with outer damage is not acceptable. A delamination that is not in combination with outer damage and not covering more than 30% of the cylinder is acceptable. No fiber strands shall be cut.
Chemical damage	Chemical attack would appear as the dissolution of the resin matrix surrounding the fibers, the cylinder surface feeling sticky when touched. The cylinder shall be rendered unservicable.	Chemical attack resulting in damage to the resin matrix surrounding the fibers is not acceptable.
Damage of casing	The casing shall be inspected in order to determine that it is intact. A cylinder with a casing that is broken or damaged in such a way that it will not be able to protect the cylinder satisfactorily shall be put aside for maintenance. Examples of such damage are broken foot rings, broken handles, etc.	Minor damage that does not affect the protecting function of the casing is acceptable. Acceptable damage can be, for example, small cracks. If it cannot be established that the cylinder is unaffected, the cylinder shall be put aside for further investigation. Unacceptable damage is, for example, a broken casing. The casing is then to be removed and the cylinder inspected underneath. A damaged cylinder is unacceptable. If the cylinder is not damaged, a new casing can be assembled.

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Heat/fire damage of the casing or cylinder	Heat or fire damage may be evident by discoloration, scarring or burning of the composite overwrap, casing, labels, and non-metallic components of the valve. Cylinders with this type of damage shall be rendered unserviceable.	Visible damage from heat and/or fire is unacceptable.
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APPENDIX B
DOT FRP-1 STANDARD
BASIC REQUIREMENTS FOR FIBER REINFORCED PLASTIC (FRP)
TYPE 3FC COMPOSITE CYLINDERS

DOT FRP - 1 STANDARD

DATE: Original; July 1, 1981
Revision 1; March 15, 1982
Revision 2; February 15, 1987

BASIC REQUIREMENTS FOR FIBER REINFORCED PLASTIC (FRP)
TYPE 3FC COMPOSITE CYLINDERS

§ 178.AA Fiber reinforced plastic (FRP) full (wrapped) composite (FC) cylinders made of definitely prescribed materials.

§ 178.AA-1 General.

Each cylinder must conform with these basic requirements and the specific requirements of the applicable special permit.

§ 178.AA-2 Type, size and service pressure.

Type 3FC cylinder consisting of resin impregnated continuous filament windings in both longitudinal and circumferential directions only over a seamless aluminum liner; not over 200 pounds water capacity; and service pressure at least 900 PSI but not greater than 5000 PSI.

§ 178.AA-3 Inspection by whom and where.

Inspections and verifications must be performed by an independent inspection agency approved in writing by the Director for the Office of Hazardous Materials Transportation (OHMT), in accordance with 49 CFR 173.300a. Chemical analyses and tests must be made in the United States unless otherwise approved in writing by the Director for OHMT in accordance with 49 CFR 173.300b.

§ 178.AA-4 Duties of the inspector.

(a) Determine that all materials conform with the provisions of this standard before releasing them for cylinder manufacture.

(b) Verify chemical analysis of each heat of liner material by analysis or by obtaining producers certified analysis. A certification from the manufacturer indicating conformance with this requirement is acceptable when verified by check analysis on one sample taken from one cylinder liner out of each inspection lot of 200 cylinders or less. Verify conformance of filament and resin system components with the requirements specified in § 178.AA-5.

(c) Prior to the initial shipment of any specific composite cylinder design, verify that the design qualification tests prescribed in § 178.AA-18 have been performed with acceptable results.

(d) Verify conformance of completed cylinder with all requirements including marking, condition of inside, heat treatment, and threads. Report minimum thickness of liner wall noted.

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(e) Verify winding process to assure that composite material is uniform, of required thickness and pattern, and in accordance with the composite structure present in cylinders subjected to the design qualification tests.

(f) Witness all tests and pressurization, obtain copies of all test results and certifications; report volumetric capacity, permanent expansion and completed composite cylinder weight.

(g) Furnish completed inspector's report (§ 178.AA-16) to the maker of the cylinder and upon request, to the purchaser. (See § 178.AA-17).

§ 178.AA-5 Authorized material and identification of material.

(a) Aluminum liner must be 6351 or 6061 alloy and T6 temper.

(b) Filament material must be commercial Type-S or commercial Type-E fiberglass. Filaments must be tested in accordance with ASTM D-2343-79 and have minimum strand strength as follows:

(1) Type-S Glass ---- 400,000 PSI.

(2) Type-E Glass ---- 200,000 PSI.

(c) Resin system must be epoxy or modified epoxy type. Resin system must be tested on sample coupons representative of the composite over-wrap in accordance with ASTM D-2344-67 for water boil shear test, and have a minimum shear strength of 5,000 PSI.

(d) Materials must be identified by a suitable method during manufacture.

(e) Materials must be of uniform quality. Materials with injurious defects are not authorized.

§ 178.AA-6 Manufacture.

(a) **Liner.** Aluminum liner must have dirt and scale removed as necessary to afford proper inspection; no defect that is likely to weaken the finished liner appreciably is authorized; reasonably smooth and uniform surface finish is required. No interior folding in the neck area is permitted; smooth gathering of the material in the neck in which there are no sharp rooted folds is acceptable. If not originally free from such defect, the liner surface may be machined or otherwise treated to eliminate these defects provided the required minimum wall thickness is maintained. Liner end contour must be concave to pressure.

(b) **Composite cylinder.** The composite cylinder must be fabricated from an aluminum liner fully overwrapped with resin impregnated continuous filament windings. Winding pattern must be "helical" or "in plane and hoop" wrap, applied under controlled tension to develop the design composite thickness. After winding is complete, the composite must be cured by a controlled temperature profile, and auto-frettagged by pressurizing to not less than 105 and not greater than 115 percent of the prescribed minimum test pressure. No defect that is likely to weaken the finished cylinder appreciably is acceptable.

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(c) **Welding or brazing.** Welding or brazing for any purpose whatsoever is prohibited.

(d) **Lot size.**

(1) **Liner lot size.** A "liner lot" means a group of liners successively produced having the same: size and configuration; specified material of construction; process of manufacture and heat treatment; equipment of manufacture and heat treatment; and conditions of time, temperature and atmosphere during heat treatment.

(2) **Composite cylinder lot size.** A "composite cylinder lot" means a group of cylinders successively produced from qualified liners, having the same size and configuration, the same specified materials of construction, the same process of manufacture to the same cylinder specification and auto-frettagged under the same conditions of temperature, time and pressure.

(3) In no case may the lot size exceed 200 units; however, any unit processed for use in the required destructive tests need not be counted as one of the 200, but must have been processed with the lot.

(e) **Design qualification tests.** Prior to initial shipment of any specific cylinder design, qualification tests as prescribed in § 178.AA-18 must have been performed with satisfactory results.

§ 178.AA-7 Wall thickness.

(a) Minimum thickness of the liner must be such that after auto-frettagage, the compressive stress in the sidewall of the liner at zero pressure will not exceed 95 percent of the minimum yield strength of the aluminum as determined in § 178.AA-12(a) or 95 percent of the minimum design yield strength shown in § 178.AA-18(h). The maximum tensile stress of the liner at operating pressure must not exceed 60 percent of the yield strength.

(b) The maximum filament stress at service pressure must not exceed 30 percent of the filament stress at the virgin burst pressure of the lot test cylinder.

(c) The end designs must incorporate added materials to assure the stresses in these areas are less than the stresses found in the cylindrical portion.

(d) Stresses shall be computed from Computer Code NASA CF-72124 "Computer Program for the Analysis of Filament-Wound Reinforced Metal Shell Pressure Vessels" May 1966, or other suitable analysis techniques.

§ 178.AA-8 Openings.

(a) Openings are permitted on the heads only. Center line of openings must coincide with the longitudinal axis of the cylinder.

(b) Threads are required. Threads must be clean cut, even, without checks and to gauge.

(c) Tapered threads are not permitted.

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(d) Straight threads conforming with National Gas Straight (NGS) thread standard are authorized. These threads must conform to the requirements of Federal Standard (FED-STD)-H28 (1978). Other straight threads having at least 6 engaged threads are authorized provided that the calculated shear strength is at least 10 times the test pressure of the cylinder.

§ 178.AA-9 Thermal treatment.

(a) The aluminum liner must be solution heat treated and aged to the T-6 temper after all forming operations and prior to pressurizing and overwrapping.

(b) The resin must be cured at the temperature specified and by the process set forth in the cylinder manufacturer's specification and noted in the Inspector's report. Curing temperature and process must correspond with that applied to the cylinders subjected to the qualification tests. The curing temperature must not exceed 350 ° F.

§ 178.AA-10 Pressure relief devices and protection for valves, relief devices, and other connections.

Pressure relief devices and protection for valves and other connections must conform with 49 CFR 173.34(d) and 173.301(g), except that the adequacy of the pressure relief devices for each design may be verified in accordance with § 178.AA-18(g).

§ 178.AA-11 Nondestructive tests.

(a) Hydrostatic test.

(1) By water-jacket, operated so as to obtain accurate data. Pressure gauge must permit reading to accuracy of 1 percent in the range of 80 percent to 120 percent of test pressure. Expansion gauge must permit reading of total expansion to an accuracy of either 1 percent or 0.1 cubic centimeter.

(2) The accuracy of the test equipment must be maintained by periodic recalibration. Records must be maintained to verify that the test equipment is calibrated on a regular basis. A calibration cylinder capable of verifying the equipment accuracy for the material, size and test pressure of the cylinders to be tested must be used for checking the equipment at the beginning of each day.

(3) Pressure must be maintained for 30 seconds and sufficiently longer to insure complete expansion. Any internal pressure applied after auto-fretting and previous to the official test must not exceed 90 percent of the test pressure. If, due to failure of test apparatus, the test pressure can not be maintained, the test may be repeated at a pressure increased by 10 percent or 100 PSI, whichever is lower. Not more than 2 such repeated tests are permitted.

(4) Each cylinder must be tested to at least 5/3 times service pressure. In no case may the test pressure exceed the auto-fretting pressure.

§ 178.AA-12 **Destructive tests.**

(a) **Physical tests.** To determine yield strength, tensile strength and elongation of the aluminum liner material. Applies to aluminum liner only.

(1) Required on 2 specimens cut from one liner taken at random out of each lot of 200 liners or less.

(2) Specimens must be: gauge length of 2 inches with width not over 1-1/2 inches; or gauge length of 4 times the specimen diameter (4D bar), provided that a specimen with gauge length at least 24 times thickness with width not over 6 times thickness is authorized when liner wall is not over 3/16 inch thick. The specimen, exclusive of grip ends, must not be flattened. Grip ends may be flattened to within one inch of each end of the reduced section. When size of liner does not permit securing straight specimens, the specimens may be taken in any location or direction and may be straightened or flattened cold and by pressure only, not by blows. When such specimens are used, the inspector's report must show that the specimens were so taken and prepared. Heating of specimens for any purpose is not authorized.

(3) The yield strength in tension shall be the stress corresponding to a permanent strain of 0.2 percent of the gauge length.

(i) The yield strength shall be determined by either the "offset" method or the "extension under load" method as prescribed by ASTM Standard E8-78.

(ii) In using the "extension under load" method, the total strain or "extension under load" corresponding to the stress at which the 0.2 percent permanent strain occurs may be determined with sufficient accuracy by calculating the elastic extension of the gauge length under appropriate load and adding thereto 0.2 percent of the gauge length. Elastic extension calculations shall be based on an elastic modulus of 10,000,000. In the event of controversy, the entire stress-strain diagram shall be plotted and the yield strength determined from the 0.2 percent offset.

(iii) For the purpose of strain measurement, the initial strain shall be set while the specimen is under a stress of 6,000 pounds per square inch, the strain indicator reading being set at the calculated corresponding strain.

(iv) Cross-head speed of the testing machine shall not exceed 1/8 inch per minute during yield strength determination.

(b) **Cycling test.** One cylinder taken at random out of each lot of 200 cylinders must be subjected to cyclic pressurization test by hydrostatically pressurizing the cylinder between approximately zero PSIG and the designated pressure at a rate not to exceed 4 cycles per minute. Adequate recording instrumentation must be provided if the equipment is to be left unattended for periods of time. All cylinders used in the cycle test must be destroyed.

(c) **Burst test.** One cylinder taken at random out of each lot of cylinders shall be hydrostatically tested to destruction by pressurizing at a uniform rate up to minimum prescribed burst pressure, holding the

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pressure constant at minimum burst pressure for 60 seconds; and increasing the pressure to failure. The rate of pressurization must not exceed 200 PSI per second. The cylinder cycle tested in paragraph (b) (1) above may be used for this burst test.

§ 178.AA-13 Acceptable results of tests.**(a) Hydrostatic test.**

(1) The permanent volumetric expansion of the cylinder must not exceed 5 percent of the total volumetric expansion at test pressure.

(2) All cylinders failing to pass the hydrostatic test must be rejected.

(b) Physical test. Applies to aluminum liner only.

(1) Elongation must be at least 14 percent; except that an elongation of 10 percent is acceptable when the authorized specimen size is 24t x 6t.

(2) When the test results fail to meet requirements, the lot must be rejected.

(3) A retest of a rejected lot is authorized if an improper test was made due to the presence of a defect in the specimen or if the equipment or procedure was faulty. The retest must be performed on specimens taken from the same cylinder liner.

(c) Cycling test.

(1) Each test cylinder must withstand at least 10,000 pressurization between approximately zero and service pressure followed by at least 30 pressurizations between zero and test pressure, without evidence of distortion or failure.

(2) When the test cylinder fails to withstand the cycle test, the lot represented must be rejected.

(d) Burst test.

(1) Burst pressure shall be at least 3 times the service pressure and in no case less than the value necessary to meet the stress criteria of § 178.AA-7(b). Failure must initiate in the cylinder sidewall. Cylinders with marked service pressure not exceeding 2,200 PSI must remain in one piece. Actual burst pressure must be recorded.

(2) When the test cylinder fails to withstand pressure up to the minimum prescribed burst pressure, the lot represented must be rejected.

§ 178.AA-14 Rejected liners and cylinders.

(a) **Physical test.** Reheat treatment of aluminum liners that failed the physical test is authorized. Subsequent thereto, acceptable liners must pass all prescribed tests.

(b) **Hydrostatic test.** Cylinders rejected by the hydrostatic test must not be placed in service.

(c) **Cycle test.** Cylinders of lots rejected by the cycle test must not be placed in service.

(d) **Burst test.** Cylinders of lots rejected by the burst test must not be placed in service.

§ 178.AA-15 Marking.

(a) Each cylinder must be permanently marked (other than stamping in the filament wrap) in the epoxy coating on the side near the end of the cylinder containing the valve outlet.

(b) Required markings are as follows:

(1) DOT-SP ****-YYYY (where ****=Special permit number, and YYYY = service pressure in PSIG).

(2) A serial number and an identifying symbol (letters); location of serial number to be just below or immediately following the DOT mark; location of symbol to be just below or immediately following the number. The symbol and number must be those of the maker. The symbol must be registered with the Director for OHMT; duplications not authorized.

(3) The Inspector's official mark must be placed near the serial number.

(4) Date of test (month and year) so placed that dates of subsequent tests can be easily added.

(5) Examples of cylinder marking:

DOT-SP ****-2000
1234-XY
AB
3-81
or;

DOT-SP ****-2000-1234-XY-AB-3-81

(c) Size of marks must be at least 1/4 inch high if space permits.

(d) Additional markings are permitted (in the epoxy coating).

§ 178.AA-16 Inspector's report.

(a) The inspector must prepare a report that is clear, legible and in accordance with the following form:

**REPORT OF MANUFACTURE OF FIBER REINFORCED PLASTIC (FRP) TYPE 3FC
FULL COMPOSITE (FC) ALUMINUM LINED COMPRESSED GAS CYLINDER.**

(Place)
(Date)
(Special permit number)

Manufactured for _____ Company.
Located at _____

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Manufactured by _____ Company.

Located at _____

Consigned to _____ Company.

Located at _____

Quantity _____ Size _____ inches outside diameter by _____ inches long

Marks placed on the _____ of the cylinder are:

DOT-SP

Serial numbers _____ to _____ inclusive.

Identifying symbol (Registered)

Inspector's mark (Registered)

Test date(s)

Other marks (if any)

Each composite cylinder was made by completely overwrapping a seamless aluminum liner with resin impregnated filament reinforcement. Composite overwrap was made by winding resin impregnated _____ continuous filament over this liner in both longitudinal and circumferential directions, followed by curing the resin at controlled temperature.

The aluminum was identified by heat numbers and verified as to chemical analysis, record thereof is attached hereto. Liners fabricated from the aluminum were solution heat treated and artificially aged to T-6 temper. Physical tests were made in the presence of the inspector and report of test results is attached hereto.

Each liner was inspected before and after closing in the ends. All that were inspected were found to be free from seams, cracks, lamination and other defects which might prove injurious to the strength of the cylinder.

Liner walls were measured and the minimum thickness noted was at least equal to the minimum design thickness. the outside diameter was found by a close approximation to be _____ inches.

Filament and resin were certified by the manufacturers, and identified by package number. Filament was verified as to strand strength. Composite was verified as to shear strength. After wrapping, composite was cured per manufacturers's specification.

Prescribed auto-frettage and hydrostatic tests were made in the presence of the inspector. All cylinders accepted conform with the specification requirements. Results of auto-frettage and hydrostatic tests are attached hereto.

Tensile stress on the aluminum liner is calculated to be _____ PSI at service pressure. Filament stress is calculated to be _____ PSI in the hoop direction and _____ PSI in the longitudinal direction at service pressure.

I hereby certify that all of these cylinders proved satisfactory in every way and conform with the requirements of DOT-SP _____ ; except as follows:

Exceptions taken to any reporting or testing requirements of this special permit are:

(Signed)

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(Inspector)

RECORD OF CHEMICAL ANALYSES OF MATERIAL FOR LINER

(Place)

(Date)

(Special permit number)

Serial numbers _____ to _____ inclusive.

Size _____ inches outside diameter by _____ inches long.

Made by _____ Company.

For _____ Company.

Material description _____.

NOTE: Any omission of analyses by heats, if authorized, must be accounted for by notation herein reading "The prescribed certificate of the manufacturer of material has been secured, found satisfactory, and placed on file." or by attaching a copy of the certificate.

Alloy	Cylinders	Chemical Analyses										
Designation	Represented											Others
	(Serial											
	Numbers)	Si	Fe	Cu	Mn	Mg	Cr	Zn	Ti	Ea.	Total	Al

Material was manufactured and mill analyses made by _____.
Originals of the certified mill analyses reports are in files of the material manufacturer.

(Signed)

(Inspector)

February 3, 2006**RECORD OF PHYSICAL TESTS OF MATERIAL FOR LINERS.**

(Place)

(Date)

(Special permit Number)

Serial numbers _____ to _____ inclusive.

Size _____ inches outside diameter by _____ inches long.

Made by _____ Company

For _____ Company

Test specimen description _____.

Lot Code	Cylinders Represented by Test.	Yield Strength at 0.2 percent Offset (pounds per square inch)	Tensile Strength (pounds per square inch)	Elongation (percent)
	(Serial Nos)			

(Signed)

(Inspector)

REPORT OF COMPOSITE ANALYSES

(Place)

(Date)

(Special permit number)

Materials

Manufactured by _____ Company

For _____ Company

Numbered

Filament specification and designation

Manufactured by _____ Company

Manufacturing package number	Tensile strength	Inter-laminar shear strength
---------------------------------	------------------	---------------------------------

**RESIN SYSTEM COMPONENTS
MANUFACTURING BATCH NUMBERS**

Resin		Curing agent		Accelerator	
Batch number	Type	Batch number	Type	Batch number	Type

(Signed)

(Inspector)

February 3, 2006**REPORT OF HYDROSTATIC TEST FOR FRP TYPE 3FC CYLINDERS**

(Place)

(Date)

(Special permit number)

_Manufactured by:

_Located at:

_Manufactured for:

_Located at:

Serial numbers: _____ to _____ inclusive.

_Symbol

Minimum prescribed test pressure _____ psig.

<u>Weight - pounds</u> <u>(without valve)</u>				Hydrostatic test				
Serial number	Liner	Compo- site	Volume Total cu.in	Auto-	Total	Perma-	Ratio	Actual
				fret- tage pressure psig	expan- sion cu.in	expan- sion cu.in	of PE to TE percent	test sure psig

LOT CYCLING AND BURST TESTS

Type of test	Serial Number of cylinder	Number of pressurizations		Burst pressure (psig)
		to service pressure	to test pressure	
<u>Cycling</u>				
Virgin Burst				

§ 178.AA-17 Retention of inspector's report.

The inspector's report (§ 178.AA-16) must be retained for 15 years from the original test date on the cylinder by the maker and the inspector.

§ 178.AA-18 Design qualification tests.

(a) **General** - Except as authorized in § 178.AA-10(a), the qualification tests as prescribed in this paragraph shall have been performed on representative cylinders of each specific design prior to any initial shipment. All cylinders used for design qualification tests must be fabricated on the same equipment and subjected to the same processes as is used to produce cylinders intended for charging and shipment. All tests must be witnessed by an independent inspector. Test reports must be kept on file by the cylinder maker and made available to the independent inspector and the OHMT upon request.

(b) **Design changes.** For purposes of this standard, a design change is: (1) any change in material; (2) a 10 percent or greater change in diameter or service pressure; or (3) a 30 percent or greater change in water capacity.

(c) **Test requirements.** Each cylinder design or any design change to an approved cylinder design must be qualified by subjecting representative cylinders to the tests prescribed in the following table:

Type of test	ORIGINAL DESIGN	DESIGN CHANGE				
		Material	Diameter or Service pressure		Water capacity	
			10 to 20 percent change	Greater than 20 percent change	30 to 50 percent change	Greater than 50 percent change
Cycling-Ambient	X	X	X	X	X	X
Cycling-Environmental	X	X	-	X	-	X
Cycling-Thermal	X	X	-	X	-	X
Hydraulic burst	X	X	X	X	X	X
Gunfire	X	X	X	X	X	X
Bonfire	X	X	X	X	X	X

(d) **Pressure cycling tests.** All cycling tests shall be performed by hydrostatically pressurizing the cylinder between approximately zero and designated pressure at a rate not in excess of 4 cycles per minute. All cylinders used in cycle tests must be destroyed. Adequate recording instrumentation must be provided if equipment is to be left unattended for periods of time.

(1) **Cycling test at ambient temperature.** One representative cylinder shall be cycle tested at ambient temperature without showing evidence of distortion, deterioration or failure, as follows: pressurize from approximately zero to service pressure for 10,000 cycles; then pressurize from approximately zero to test pressure for at least 30 cycles. After successfully passing this test the cylinder must be pressurized to burst in accordance with paragraph (e) (1) of this section and the burst pressure recorded.

(2) **Environmental cycling test.** One representative cylinder free of any protective coating shall be cycle tested without showing evidence of distortion, deterioration or failure as follows. Any cylinder subjected to this cycling test must be destroyed.

(i) Condition the cylinder for 48 hours at zero pressure, 140 °F. or higher and 95 percent or greater relative humidity.

(ii) Pressurize from zero to service pressure for 5,000 cycles at 140 °F. or higher and 95 percent or greater relative humidity.

(iii) Stabilize at zero pressure and ambient conditions.

(iv) Then pressurize from zero to service pressure for 5,000 cycles at -60 °F. or lower.

(v) Stabilize at zero pressure and ambient temperature conditions.

(vi) Then pressurize from zero to test pressure for 30 cycles at ambient temperature.

(3) **Thermal cycling test.** One representative cylinder shall be tested without showing evidence of distortion, deterioration or failure as follows. After successfully passing this test, the cylinder must be pressurized to burst in accordance with paragraph (e)(1) of this section and burst pressure recorded.

(i) Cycle test at ambient temperature by performing 10,000 pressurizations from approximately zero to service pressure and at least 30 pressurizations from zero to test pressure.

(ii) Then hydrostatically pressurize to service pressure; and submerge the pressurized cylinder in 200 °F. fluid, soak for 10 minutes; transfer and submerge in -60 °F. fluid and soak for 10 minutes. Subject cylinder to 20 such cycles restricting the transfer time to at least one minute but not more than 3 minutes. The pressure in the cylinder may be controlled so that it does not exceed test pressure nor less than marked service pressure.

(e) **Hydraulic burst test.**

(1) One representative cylinder shall be hydrostatically pressurized to failure as follows: pressure shall be increased at a uniform rate up to minimum prescribed burst pressure; this pressure to be held for at least 60 seconds; then pressure will be further increased to failure. The pressurization rate throughout the test must not exceed 200 psi per second.

(2) Burst pressure must be at least 3 times the marked service pressure, and in no case less than the value necessary to meet the stress criteria of § 178.AA-7(b). Failure must initiate in the sidewall. Cylinders with marked service pressure not exceeding 2200 psi must remain in one piece. Actual burst pressure must be recorded.

(f) **Gunfire Test.** One representative cylinder charged with air or nitrogen to service pressure shall be impacted by a 0.30 caliber armor-piercing projectile having a velocity of approximately 2800 feet per second. Cylinder shall be positioned so that the projectile impact point is in the cylinder sidewall having hoop winding, at approximately 45 degree angle and aimed to exit at the cylinder sidewall. Distance from firing location to test cylinder must not exceed 50 yards. Tested cylinder shall reveal no evidence of a fragmentation failure. Approximate size of entrance and exit openings must be recorded.

(g) **Bonfire test.** Test cylinders must be fitted with pressure relief devices in accordance with § 178.AA-10 and charged with the intended lading to the prescribed filling pressure or density. Charging with nitrogen or air to service pressure is authorized only if cylinders

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are to be charged only with non-liquefied gases. Fire for the test shall be generated by kerosine-soaked wood, gasoline or JP-4 fuel. The lowest part of the cylinder shall be approximately 4 inches above the base of the fire when wood fire is used or shall be approximately 4 inches above the liquid surface if gasoline or JP-4 fuel is used. Test cylinder shall be exposed to fire until completely vented. Time-pressure readings must be recorded at 30 second intervals from start of fire until venting is completed. Test results are not acceptable if contents vent from any location other than through a pressure relief device. After successfully passing the fire test, each cylinder must be pressurized to burst and burst pressure recorded. Tests must be performed as follows:

- (1) **Vertical test.** Place test cylinder in its upright position and subject to total fire engulfment but in no case shall the flame be allowed to impinge directly on any relief device. Shielding of pressure relief devices with a metal plate may be used but is not a requirement. For cylinders equipped with relief devices on both ends, the bottom relief devices must be shielded from any flame impingement.
- (2) **Horizontal tests.** Place test cylinder in its upright position and subject the entire length to flame impingement except that the flame must not be allowed to impinge directly on any relief device. Shielding of the pressure relief devices with a metal plate may be used but is not a requirement.
- (3) **Cylinders for liquified gas service.** At least one representative cylinder must be subjected to the horizontal test and two to the vertical test.
- (4) **Cylinders for non-liquefied gas service only.** At least 2 cylinders must be subjected to the vertical test. Horizontal test is not required.
- (h) **Qualification test results.** A report of all tests for each design qualification, describing test setup, procedure and results must be submitted to the OHMT. This report must include at least the following basic information on each cylinder design tested.

BASIC CYLINDER DESIGN INFORMATION

Dimension, material and pressure data.

(Date)
 (Special permit number)

Cylinder:

Service pressure	_____	PSIG
Volume	_____	cu. in.
Outside diameter of cylinder	_____	inches
Total weight of cylinder	_____	pounds
Auto-frettage pressure (Note 1)	_____	PSIG
Test pressure	_____	PSIG
Minimum prescribed burst pressure	_____	PSIG
Calculated burst pressure	_____	PSIG
Nominal thickness of overwrap	_____	inches
Minimum strand strength of filament	_____	PSI
Minimum shear strength of resin	_____	PSI

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Weight of composite material pounds

Liner:

Weight of liner pounds

Inside diameter inches

Liner material and temper ...

Filament material

Resin material

Minimum wall thickness of liner (Qual. test cyl). inches

Minimum design wall thickness of liner inches

Yield strength of liner (Qual. test cyl) PSI

Minimum design yield strength of liner PSI

Note 1. For each qualification test cylinder, the total and permanent volumetric expansion readings obtained in the auto-fretage pressurizations must be recorded.

DESIGN STRESSES AND LOAD DISTRIBUTION

	STRESS		LOAD	
	Direction		Distribution (%)	
	Long.	Circ.	Liner	Overwrap
Pressure	X	-	-	-
Zero	-	X	-	-
	X	-	-	-
Service	-	X	-	-
	X	-	-	-
Test	-	X	-	-
*Minimum	X	-	-	-
Burst	-	X	-	-

*Based on §178.AA-7